

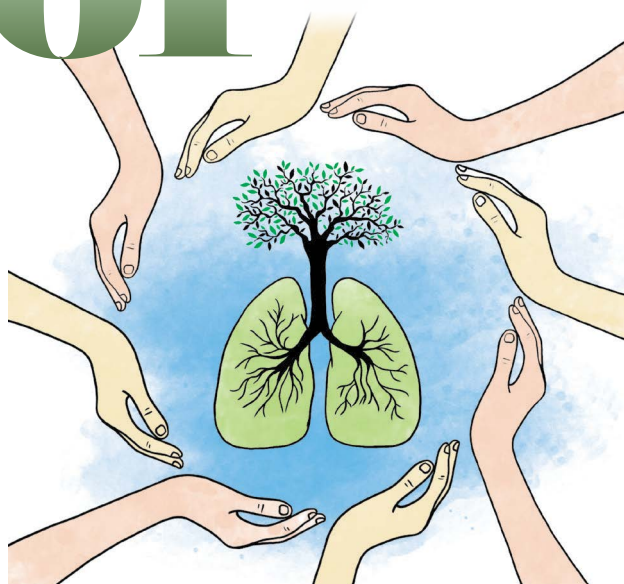
AIR POLLUTION PREVENTION POLICY

► A recent report says that 13 of the world's 20 most polluted cities are in India. Air pollution is not a metro city problem anymore as several Tier-II and Tier-II cities are also on the list of the world's most polluted cities. What is needed is a comprehensive district-wise graded air pollution road map with the involvement of all stakeholders. Transparency in data generation and consistency are the key to finding a solution rather than knee-jerk reactions during high-pollution days.



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FASTER PROJECT CLEARANCES

► Several central and state infrastructure projects face cost and time overruns with agencies complaining about land acquisition and environment clearances. A single-window clearance system, Parivesh, was launched to streamline and expedite green clearances, but states continue to operate at their own pace. Concerns have been aired regarding dilution of environmental laws. A more consultative system needs to be evolved to balance environment protection with developmental needs.

TURN WASTE TO WEALTH

► Waste management remains one of the biggest challenges with segregation, reduction, recycling and reuse measures requiring a holistic approach. Integrated water, sanitation, and waste systems can check pollution. With e-waste becoming a big challenge, producer responsibility needs to be expanded with a recycle/disposal tracking system. A formalised marketplace for recyclable waste trading and incentivising waste pickers can address the challenges.

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